

Sunday Menu — Reverse-Seared Little Joe Ribeye

Three covers. Bone-in Little Joe Grass Fed MB4+, 1.160 kg, 5.5 cm. Floating service, predicted 6:44–7:09 pm. Governance framework v3.5.

The Menu

- Reverse-seared bone-in ribeye, prescribed sear with a four-point measurement series
- Salsa verde (made ahead, refrigerated; anchovy portion served separately)
- Pommes purée (made during the low roast, held over a bain-marie)
- Sautéed mushrooms with thyme
- Watercress with mustard vinaigrette (dressed at the table)

Register: bistro. The steak is the point; everything else either cuts it or stays out of the way. The plate is deliberately light on live workflow — two components need no heat at all — because this cook exists to take measurements, and those need attention that is not competing with a sauce.

Meal Balance Audit

Richness: ribeye and a butter-rich purée. No butter sauce and no fried starch — the salsa verde replaces a butter mount with oil and acid, so the fat present works harder and stacks less.

Acid — two sources, distinct functions: red wine vinegar in the salsa verde cuts the steak's fat directly; the vinaigrette on the watercress is a lighter reset between mouthfuls. The same vinegar in both, deliberately — a third acid character would fragment a plate this simple.

Sweetness: none added anywhere. The only sweetness is browning on the steak and mushrooms. Adding a sweet element would fight the grass-fed character.

Texture: seared crust, tender interior, soft purée, browned mushroom, raw peppery watercress. Purée is entirely soft — the mushrooms and watercress carry the contrast, so do not drop the mushrooms.

Temperature: steak and purée hot, mushrooms warm, watercress deliberately cold. Plates warmed — this addresses the negative-carryover finding from the salmon cook.

Accumulation risk: the purée. At 450 g raw against roughly 900 g of carved beef it is correctly sized as a spoonful under the steak rather than a mound alongside.

No dessert. If wanted, a reset — citrus or poached fruit.

Meal Workflow

Critical Path

Steak oven exit → 8 min rest → prescribed sear → 10 min rest → carve. A fixed 29-minute convergence sequence including measurement time.

Strategy: fixed convergence, floating service. The low-roast band cannot be predicted closely enough for a fixed service time, so the variance lands in service rather than in a hold window. Everything after the oven exit is measured from that instant, written E+. Set a timer at the exit and stop watching the clock. 7:00 pm is not a target.

Failure Prioritization

Protect the steak's internal temperature above everything. There is one piece and no backup.

- If the sear runs long, serve the mushrooms cooler.
- If the purée tightens, loosen it with warm milk. Do not hold the steak for it.
- If the steak has not reached 120°F / 49°C, wait. Service moves.
- If a measurement and a cooking step collide, take the measurement. Everything else on this plate holds or recovers.

Oven Sequencing

225°F / 107°C, constant, steak only. No mid-cook temperature change. At exit, drop to 170°F / 77°C, crack the door two minutes to speed the drop, and put the plates in. Nothing else competes for the oven at any point.

Heat Resource Allocation

Resource	Component	Window
Oven	Steak low-roast, then plate warming	5:15 pm → service
Induction 1	Potatoes boiling, then purée	5:25 → 6:13 pm
Induction 2	Purée bain-marie hold	6:13 pm → service
Outdoor gas 1	Mushrooms	E+8 → E+18
Outdoor gas 2	Steak sear	E+8 → E+12:30

Burner-count validation: peak concurrency at E+8 — induction 2 plus outdoor gas 1 and 2. Three of five available burners, two spare. The sear is outdoors deliberately: high heat, heavy smoke, away from indoor extraction.

Parallel vs. Sequential

Parallel: mushrooms and the sear, both starting at E+8. The purée runs against the low roast, not the convergence.

Sequential, non-overlappable: exit → rest → sear → rest → carve.

No component depends on the sear fond. The salsa verde is made hours earlier and there is no pan sauce, which removes the tightest timing dependency this workflow would otherwise carry.

Low-Roast Allowance — Planning Only

60–85 minutes for this piece: 1.160 kg bone-in, 5.5 cm, fridge-cold, 225°F / 107°C, to a 120°F / 49°C pull.

Longer and wider than a boneless steak of the same thickness, for two compounding reasons. Bone insulates the face it sits against, slowing the centre. And at 1.160 kg the thermal centre is further from every surface, not only the top and bottom — thickness still governs, but a piece this large extends beyond what a thickness model predicts.

This is outside the range of any data point available and is a scheduling estimate, not a doneness prediction. Probe temperature controls.

Holding Chain

Component	Vessel & Condition	Planned Max Hold	Drift	Corrective
Salsa verde	Covered, refrigerated; out 45 min before service	24 hr cold	Parsley darkens	Cosmetic. Stir and re-taste after tempering
Purée	Bain-marie, covered, low	60 min	Tightens, skins over	Beat in warm milk 1 tbsp at a time
Mushrooms	Pan off heat, uncovered	12 min	Steam softens the browning	Do not cover
Steak, pre-sear	Rack, uncovered, room temp	Fixed 8 min	Internal drops — this is measurement B	None; the window is fixed
Steak, post-sear	Warmed plate, uncovered, not tented	Fixed 10 min	Tenting traps steam and degrades the crust	Never tent
Vinaigrette	Jar, room temperature	4 hr	Separates	Shake before use
Watercress	Undressed, damp cloth, fridge	4 hr	Wilts once dressed	Dress at the table

On the 10-minute post-sear rest: set at 10 rather than 8 because 1.160 kg wants the longer rest, and fixed so that measurement D is comparable against future cooks. This is the baseline cook, so 10 becomes the reference. It is not established that 10 beats a shorter rest on the plate — designed, not validated.

Timeline Verification

Forward: load 5:15 pm → 60–85 min → exit 6:15–6:40 pm → 29 min convergence → service 6:44–7:09 pm.

Band closure, both ends: earliest exit 6:15 gives a 29-minute hold on the purée; latest exit 6:40 gives 54 minutes. Both sit inside the 60-minute bain-marie ceiling. The convergence is a fixed 29 minutes at both ends, so the entire 25-minute spread lands in service time and no hold window absorbs it.

Purée timing note: the purée completes around 6:13 pm, before the earliest predicted exit. If the steak runs fast it may spill a few minutes into the early convergence — which competes with nothing, since induction 1 is free from E+0 to E+8 and both outdoor burners handle the sear and mushrooms.

Final Plating Window

Plates out at E+27. A spoonful of purée, steak carved across it, mushrooms alongside. Watercress and salsa verde at the table. Two minutes from first plate to service.

Timeline — Absolute Phase

Anchored on oven load. Service floats.

Time	Action
Saturday	Pat steak dry. 9 g salt across all faces including the fat cap and the exposed bone. Uncovered on a rack, refrigerated. Do not cover; do not rinse.
~2:00 pm Sun	Salsa verde complete, covered, refrigerated. Vinaigrette mixed in a jar. Watercress washed, spun dry, wrapped in a damp cloth, refrigerated. Mushrooms cleaned and torn.
5:10 pm	Oven to 225°F / 107°C. Confirm at temperature before loading.
5:15 pm	Steak on a rack over a tray, straight from the fridge. Probe entered from the side into the centre of the eye, angled away from the bone. Alarm 120°F / 49°C. Allowance 60–85 min.
5:25 pm	Induction 1: potatoes peeled, cut even, into 1.25 L cold water with 12 g salt. Bring to a simmer, then 20–25 min at a simmer to full tenderness.
6:00 pm	Salsa verde out of the fridge to temper.
6:13 pm	Drain, steam-dry 5 min, rice. Beat in cold butter, then warm milk. Salt. Bain-marie on induction 2, covered.
6:15–6:40 pm	Steak exits on temperature, not clock. Thermopen-confirm from a second angle before removing. E+0 starts here.
6:44–7:09 pm	Predicted service.

Declared format deviation: the phase after oven exit is expressed exit-relative rather than T-minus, because the low-roast band cannot be predicted closely enough for a fixed-service timeline to close without violating a hold ceiling. The table above is the scheduling anchor; the E+ table governs on the day. Where they diverge, E+ wins.

Timeline — Exit-Relative Phase (governs on the day)

Start a timer the instant the steak leaves the oven.

Offset	Action
E+0	RECORD A — the reading at exit. Steak to a rack, uncovered. Rest 8 min. Oven to 170°F / 77°C, door cracked 2 min. Plates in.
E+8	RECORD B — pre-sear, before the steak touches the pan.
E+8	Outdoor gas 2: cast iron preheated hard, longer than feels necessary. Neutral oil shimmering. Sear 90 sec per broad face. Fat cap on edge as needed. Then lift the pan off the flame or drop to low, add butter, thyme and garlic, and baste 30 sec. No probing during the sear.
E+8	Outdoor gas 1: neutral oil, high. Mushrooms in a single layer, undisturbed 4 min, then butter, thyme, sliced garlic. 10 min total.
E+12:30	Sear off. RECORD C immediately — this reading is time-sensitive, take it before doing anything else.
E+13	Steak to a warmed plate, uncovered, not tented. Rest 10 min.
E+18	Mushrooms off heat, uncovered.
E+22	Watercress and dressing jar to the table. Check purée consistency; loosen with warm milk if it has tightened.
E+23	RECORD D — post-rest reading, plus the plate temperature taken with the same probe.
E+24	Carve the meat off the bone in one piece, then across the grain into 1 cm slices. Flaky salt on the cut surface.
E+27	Plate. Purée, steak across, mushrooms alongside.
E+29	Serve. Salsa verde and watercress at the table.

Shared Prep

Prepare these in aggregate before starting individual dishes.

Thyme: 4 sprigs — 2 to the steak baste, 2 to the mushrooms.

Red wine vinegar: 35 ml — 20 ml to the salsa verde, 15 ml to the vinaigrette.

Dijon: 2 tsp — 1 tsp to the salsa verde, 1 tsp to the vinaigrette.

Olive oil: 145 ml — 100 ml to the salsa verde, 45 ml to the vinaigrette. A primary flavour in both, not a medium — use a good one.

Butter: 125 g / 8¾ tbsp — 15 g to the steak baste, 90 g to the purée (must be cold and cubed), 20 g to the mushrooms.

Garlic is not consolidated here. The three cloves take three different preparations — finely grated for the salsa verde, smashed skin-on for the steak baste, finely sliced for the mushrooms — so each is prepared with its own dish.

Salt: Diamond Crystal kosher throughout. The 12 g for the potato water seasons the water, not the food.

Shopping List

Ingredient	Total	Steak	Salsa verde	Purée	Mushrooms
PROTEIN					
Little Joe Grass Fed MB4+ Rib Eye On Bone	1.160 kg, 5.5 cm	1 pc	—	—	—
PRODUCE					
Garlic	3 cloves	1 smashed	1 grated	—	1 sliced
Lemon	1	—	1	—	—
Mushrooms, mixed (chestnut, shiitake, oyster)	300 g / 10 oz	—	—	—	300 g
Parsley, flat-leaf	1 large bunch, ~40 g leaves	—	40 g	—	—
Potatoes, floury (Maris Piper, Desiree, russet)	450 g / 1 lb	—	—	450 g	—
Thyme, fresh	4 sprigs	2	—	—	2
Watercress	100 g / 3½ oz	—	—	—	—
PANTRY / DRY					
Anchovy fillets in oil, kept separate	4 fillets	—	4	—	—
Capers, in brine or salt	20 g / 2 tbsp	—	20 g	—	—
Dijon mustard (pantry check)	2 tsp	—	1 tsp	—	—
FRIDGE / DAIRY					
Unsalted butter	125 g / 8¾ tbsp	15 g	—	90 g	20 g
Whole milk	75 ml / ⅓ cup	—	—	75 ml	—
OILS & LIQUIDS					
Neutral oil (pantry check)	25 ml / 1½ tbsp	15 ml	—	—	10 ml
Olive oil, good quality	145 ml / ⅔ cup	—	100 ml	—	—
Red wine vinegar (pantry check)	35 ml / 2½ tbsp	—	20 ml	—	—
SEASONING					
Black pepper (pantry check)	to taste	yes	yes	—	yes
Flaky salt (pantry check)	to finish	yes	—	—	—
Kosher salt, Diamond Crystal (pantry check)	25.5 g total	9 g	1 g	12 g water + 2 g	1 g
WATERCRESS SALAD — separate column omitted for width					
Watercress · Dijon 1 tsp · red wine vinegar 15 ml · olive oil 45 ml · salt ½ g	100 g / 3½ oz	—	—	—	—

Sourcing Notes

Steak secured: Little Joe Grass Fed MB4+ Rib Eye On Bone, 1.160 kg, S\$89.90/kg, S\$104.28. Use by 11 September. Measured at 5.5 cm.

Parsley: a real bunch. A supermarket sachet will not yield 40 g of leaves, and salsa verde made short of parsley is just oily caper dressing.

Mushrooms mixed if possible. A single variety works but loses the textural range that is doing real work on this plate.

1. Reverse-Seared Bone-In Ribeye

Serves 3 with leftovers · Total: ~30 hr including brine · Active: ~12 min · Oven: 225°F / 107°C

A large bone-in grass-fed ribeye, overnight dry-brined, brought slowly to 120°F and finished with a short prescribed sear — an even rosy interior wall to wall beneath a dark crust, with no grey band.

Ingredient	Amount
Little Joe Grass Fed MB4+ Rib Eye On Bone, 5.5 cm	1.160 kg / 2 lb 9 oz
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	9 g / 3 tsp
Black pepper, coarse	at the sear
Neutral oil	15 ml / 1 tbsp
Unsalted butter	15 g / 1 tbsp
Thyme	2 sprigs
Garlic, smashed, skin on	1 clove
Flaky salt	at carving

Salting Strategy

Overnight dry brine, uncovered on a rack in the fridge, at approximately 0.8% of gross weight.

Salt dissolves, is drawn in, and the muscle reabsorbs the resulting brine — the mechanism that reduces cooking loss, and it needs hours rather than minutes. Separately, the uncovered rest dries the surface, which is what lets a 90-second face build crust rather than steam. These are two distinct operations sharing one window: the salt seasons, the air-drying conditions the surface. Neither substitutes for the other.

On a grass-fed cut this matters more, not less. Less intramuscular fat means less internal moisture buffer, so the reabsorbed brine does more work.

A window of roughly 30 hours is slightly beyond the 18–24 hr norm and is fine at this dose — beef continues to improve out to around 48 hours. No adjustment required.

Prep Phase

1. Pat every face dry with paper towel.
2. Salt all faces including the fat cap and the exposed bone end.
3. Rack in the fridge, uncovered, until the oven. Do not cover; do not rinse before cooking.

Active Cooking

1. Oven at 225°F / 107°C, confirmed at temperature and held constant throughout. Steak on a rack over a tray.
2. **Probe placement is the critical step on a bone-in cut. Enter from the side, into the centre of the eye, angled deliberately away from the bone.** Side entry makes it easier to keep the sensing tip at the coolest geometric centre; a tip sitting close to the surface, or against the bone, reads artificially high and will pull you early.
3. **Pull at 120°F / 49°C.** Thermapen-confirm from a second angle before removing. There is one piece and no backup.
4. RECORD A. Rest uncovered on a rack, 8 minutes.
5. RECORD B, before the steak touches the pan.
6. Cast iron over high outdoor gas, preheated hard — longer than feels necessary. Neutral oil to shimmering. 90 seconds per broad face. Fat cap held on edge until coloured and slumped.
7. **Lift the pan off the flame, or drop to low, before adding the butter.** Then butter, thyme and smashed garlic; baste 30 seconds. Butter and garlic will burn within seconds at sear heat on an outdoor burner.
8. RECORD C immediately off the pan.

Why the Sear Is Prescribed Rather Than Temperature-Gated

Medium-rare beef has no mandatory endpoint — anywhere from 128°F to 138°F is good eating — and that slack is what makes a prescribed sear safe here. It is also the only way the measurement works: if the sear stops at a target temperature, that target is what gets recorded, and sear gain becomes an artefact of the gate rather than an observation. Prescribe the sear; measure the consequence.

If the colour is short at 90 seconds, record that rather than silently extending — otherwise the numbers describe a different sear than the one written down.

Risk envelope: a 1.160 kg bone-in piece entering the pan near 117°F with roughly three minutes of total contact will not approach 140°F. Mass and contact time bound it, and the large thermal mass makes that bound stronger here than on a smaller steak.

The Measurement Series

Point	When	What
A	At oven exit	Leave-in reading, cross-checked with the Thermapen
B	E+8, before the pan	Pre-sear, after the 8-minute rack rest
C	Immediately off the pan	Post-sear. Time-sensitive — take it before anything else
D	E+23, after the 10-minute rest	Post-rest, plus the plate temperature with the same probe

Three deltas: pre-sear drift (B–A), sear gain (C–B), carryover (D–C). The carryover direction is genuinely open — the salmon cook showed negative carryover onto room-temperature plates, and it has never been resolved for a seared whole muscle.

Pull Temperature, Mechanism and Carryover

Oven exit 120°F / 49°C. The rise across the sear is active heating, not carryover — the two must not be conflated. No expected rise is stated here deliberately: a predicted figure alongside a prescribed protocol becomes a competing metric that invites the cook to chase a number instead of following the method.

Secondary Doneness Cue

If the probe reads within 3°F of target but the centre still feels firm with a resistant core, take a second reading from a different angle before pulling — the first placement is likely off-centre or bone-adjacent. On a bone-in cut this is the most probable measurement error, not a marginal one.

Food Safety

The USDA recommendation for whole cuts of beef is 145°F / 63°C followed by a 3-minute rest. This recipe cooks well below that, which is a deliberate quality choice and is stated as such rather than presented as equivalent.

The basis is that on intact whole-muscle beef, surface contamination does not migrate into the interior, and the sear addresses the surface. This reasoning does not apply to mechanically or blade-tenderised beef, where the needle carries surface bacteria inward — if there is any doubt whether the cut was tenderised, cook to 145°F. It also carries more risk for anyone immunocompromised, pregnant, very young or elderly.

Holding & Assembly

Post-sear rest 10 minutes on a warmed plate, uncovered. Do not tent — tenting traps steam against a crust that took a hard sear to build. Carve the meat off the bone in one piece, then across the grain into 1 cm slices. Flaky salt on the cut surface, not before.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Internal passes 140°F / 60°C — medium-well. Grey, and noticeably dry on a lean grass-fed cut	Reading C, taken immediately off the pan	Unrecoverable. The salsa verde will not rescue it
Critical	Probe sits against the bone and reads high — steak pulled well before target	Centre feels firm and resistant despite a reading near 120°F	Return to the oven and re-probe from a fresh angle. Recoverable if caught before the sear
Major	Butter and garlic burn during the baste	Acrid smell, black solids in the pan	Pan not taken off the flame. Discard the butter, wipe the pan, re-baste briefly with fresh butter off heat
Major	No crust after 90 sec per face — grey, steamed exterior	No aggressive sizzle on contact	Pan under-preheated or the surface still damp. Record the deviation, dry the face, re-sear briefly
Major	Crust burns	Very dark colour at 45 sec	Lift and reduce. Recoverable at 45 sec; past 90 sec unrecoverable for that face, dish remains serviceable
Minor	Fat cap unrendered — waxy band at the edge	Cap pale and firm rather than coloured and slumped	Return the cap edge to the pan 30 sec

Adjust: taste a slice before the salsa verde goes near it. If it reads flat, more flaky salt on the cut surface. If the fat seams read firm and waxy rather than melting — likely on this grass-fed cut, whose fat has a higher melting point than grain-fed — that is a characteristic of the beef, not a cooking error. Record it; do not cook further to correct it.

2. Salsa Verde

~150 ml, serves 3 · Active: 12 min · Made 2–24 hr ahead · No heat

A raw herb, caper and vinegar sauce, loose and spoonable — sharp and green, cutting the steak's fat with acid rather than adding more fat.

Ingredient	Amount
Parsley, flat-leaf, leaves picked	40 g / 1 large bunch
Capers, rinsed	20 g / 2 tbsp
Garlic, finely grated	1 clove
Dijon mustard	1 tsp
Red wine vinegar	20 ml / 4 tsp
Olive oil, good quality	100 ml / scant ½ cup
Lemon, zest of half	½
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	1 g / ¼ tsp
Anchovy fillets, kept separate	4

Anchovy — split at the end. Anchovy improves this sauce and does not read fishy once chopped in, but Lukas dislikes oily fish and asking him to trust that is the wrong move. Make the base without it. Reserve one-third plain for Lukas. Mash the 4 fillets to a paste and stir into the remaining two-thirds. Two bowls at the table.

Prep Phase

1. Pick the parsley leaves. Stems make it bitter and stringy.
2. Rinse the capers well. Brined capers are aggressively salty; salt-packed need a proper soak.

Active Cooking

1. **Chop the parsley and capers together by hand, medium-fine.** A food processor turns this into a smooth paste that tastes bruised and dull — visible leaf is part of the dish.
2. Combine with the grated garlic, Dijon, vinegar, lemon zest, salt and pepper.
3. Stir in the olive oil in a stream. It should be loose and spoonable, not emulsified.
4. Reserve one-third plain. Mash the anchovies to a paste and stir into the remaining two-thirds.

Holding & Assembly

Covered and refrigerated, up to 24 hours. Raw garlic held in oil at ambient temperature is a recognised botulism vector, and there is no reason to accept that exposure when refrigeration costs nothing operationally. Out 45 minutes before service to temper, then stir and re-taste — cold flattens it, and seasoning that read correctly in the fridge may need a correction once it warms.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Over-processed to a paste — bruised, dull, muddy green	Uniform smooth texture with no visible leaf	Unrecoverable. Chop by hand
Minor	Too salty — overwhelms the steak	Taste before the oil goes in	Capers under-rinsed. Add more parsley and oil to dilute
Minor	Served straight from the fridge — muted and stiff	Oil cloudy, flavour flat	Temper 45 min. Fully recoverable if the time is allowed

Adjust: taste on a piece of bread, not from a spoon — neat, it will always read too sharp. Flat calls for more vinegar; harsh calls for more oil. Salt last, after the capers have distributed, and re-check after tempering.

3. Pommes Purée

Serves 3 · Total: ~50 min · Active: ~15 min · Made during the low roast

Riced potato beaten with butter and warm milk to a smooth, glossy purée that holds a soft ribbon. Meal-level texture exemption: purée is inherently single-texture; contrast is carried by the crust, mushrooms and watercress.

Ingredient	Amount
Potatoes, floury (Maris Piper, Desiree, russet), peeled, cut even	450 g / 1 lb
Water, for boiling	1.25 L / 5 cups
Diamond Crystal kosher salt, for the water	12 g / 1 tbsp
Unsalted butter, cold, cubed	90 g / 6½ tbsp
Whole milk, warmed	75 ml / ⅓ cup
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	2 g / ½ tsp

On the butter quantity. 90 g against 450 g is 20%. Robuchon runs closer to 50%, so this is a restrained version and will still read rich. The quantity is a choice about how luxurious you want it, not a structural threshold — there is no butter level below which purée becomes gluey. Glueyness comes from starch damage through overworking, which is a technique failure rather than a ratio failure.

Prep Phase

1. Peel and cut into even 4 cm pieces. Even sizing matters more than size — mixed pieces cook unevenly and the small ones waterlog.

Active Cooking

1. Potatoes into 1.25 L cold salted water. Bring to a simmer, then 20–25 min at a simmer to full tenderness — a piece should collapse under a knife with no resistance at all. Under-cooked potato will not rice smoothly and cannot be fixed later.
2. Drain thoroughly. Steam-dry in the colander 5 min. Excess water is the main cause of a loose, bland purée.
3. **Rice while hot, into a warm pan. A ricer or food mill only** — a masher leaves lumps, and a food processor develops the starch and turns it to glue within seconds.
4. Over low heat, beat in the cold butter cube by cube until absorbed. Then the warm milk, gradually, until glossy and holding a soft ribbon. Salt.

Holding & Assembly

Bain-marie over low heat, covered, up to 60 minutes. Beat before serving. If it has tightened, add warm milk a tablespoon at a time.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Gluey, elastic texture — inedible paste	Pulls away from the spoon in sticky sheets	Over-worked starch, usually from a processor. Unrecoverable
Major	Lumpy — coarse and uneven	Visible lumps after ricing	Under-boiled. Pass through a sieve — laborious but recoverable
Minor	Too loose — runs on the plate	Will not hold a ribbon	Over low heat 3–4 min to drive off moisture
Minor	Skins over during the hold	Dry film on the surface	Cover properly. Beat the skin back in

Adjust: season after the milk, not before — the milk dilutes and you will under-salt if you season early. Taste at serving temperature; purée reads flatter hot than warm.

4. Sautéed Mushrooms with Thyme

Serves 3 · Total: 10 min · Active: 10 min · Outdoor gas

Mixed mushrooms browned hard in a single layer — deeply coloured at the edges, the plate's middle texture between soft purée and raw watercress.

Ingredient	Amount
Mushrooms, mixed (chestnut, shiitake, oyster), torn or thickly sliced	300 g / 10 oz
Neutral oil	10 ml / 2 tsp
Unsalted butter	20 g / 1½ tbsp
Thyme	2 sprigs
Garlic, finely sliced	1 clove
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	1 g / ¼ tsp

Prep Phase

1. Tear rather than slice where the variety allows — torn edges catch more colour.
2. Rinse if they need it and dry them properly. Surface moisture is the only issue; mushrooms absorb far less water than the folklore suggests.

Active Cooking

1. E+8: neutral oil in a wide pan over high outdoor gas. Mushrooms in a single layer, undisturbed 4 minutes. They release water first and then begin to colour — do not move them during this.
2. Toss. Add butter, thyme and sliced garlic. A further 6 minutes, tossing occasionally, until deeply browned at the edges.
3. **Salt after browning**, so released moisture does not slow the initial colour development. Pan heat and loading are what govern browning — an uncrowded pan at high heat is the whole technique.

Holding & Assembly

Pan off heat, uncovered, up to 12 minutes. Covering traps steam and undoes the browning.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Steamed grey, no browning — soggy and flat	Liquid pooling and not evaporating after 5 min	Pan crowded or heat too low. Raise the heat and work in two batches. Recoverable
Minor	Garlic burns	Visible blackening, acrid smell	Added too early or heat too high. Remove the slices

Adjust: if they read flat, salt and a further minute over high heat rather than more butter. Fat is not what they are missing.

5. Watercress with Mustard Vinaigrette

Serves 3 · Total: 5 min · Active: 5 min · No heat · Dressed at the table

Raw, peppery leaves with a sharp mustard vinaigrette — the plate's cold reset against a rich steak.

Ingredient	Amount
Watercress, thick stems trimmed	100 g / 3½ oz
Dijon mustard	1 tsp
Red wine vinegar	15 ml / 1 tbsp
Olive oil, good quality	45 ml / 3 tbsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	½ g / pinch

Prep Phase

1. Wash and spin thoroughly dry — wet leaves repel dressing.
2. Wrap in a damp cloth and refrigerate, up to 4 hours.

Active Cooking

1. No heat. Whisk the Dijon, vinegar, salt and pepper in a jar, then add the oil and shake to emulsify. Hold at room temperature.

Holding & Assembly

Dress at the table, not in the kitchen. Watercress wilts within two or three minutes of contact with vinaigrette. A bowl of leaves and the jar of dressing, poured and tossed in front of everyone — which also lets each person take as much as they want of an assertive leaf.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Dressed too early — limp, dark, collapsed	Leaves darkening and losing structure	Unrecoverable. Dress at the table
Minor	Dressing will not emulsify	Oil sitting separate after shaking	More Dijon, shake again

Adjust: watercress already reads peppery and saline, so under-salt the vinaigrette rather than over-salt it. Taste on a leaf, not from the jar.

Designed, Not Validated — Post-Cook Confirmation Candidates

These parameters were engineered for this cook and have not been observed. Record each against actual and log to the Vault.

#	Parameter
1	Sear gain (C–B) across a standardised 90-second-per-face sear. The primary objective of this cook, outstanding since before the pork cook.
2	Carryover (D–C) across the 10-minute post-sear rest onto warmed plates, with plate temperature recorded. Direction genuinely open — the salmon cook showed negative carryover onto room-temperature plates.
3	Pre-sear drift (B–A) across the 8-minute rack rest. The first measurement of what that rest actually costs.
4	Low-roast allowance of 60–85 min for 1.160 kg bone-in at 5.5 cm. A scheduling estimate outside the range of any existing data point; this cook produces the first beef reference.
5	Overnight dry brine at ~0.8% gross on beef — whether seasoning reads through the cut, and whether the surface dried enough for a 90-second face.
6	Whether 10 minutes is the right post-sear rest for a piece this size, as distinct from a standardised one.
7	Grass-fed MB4+ fat behaviour at reverse-sear temperatures — whether the seams read firm and waxy rather than melting.
8	Purée bain-marie hold across the full 29–54 minute spread.

Items 1 to 3 are why this menu was built light. Everything else on the plate holds, so if anything competes for your attention at E+8, E+12:30 or E+23, take the reading.